CONNECT DAILY

Friday 13 November 2026
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A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

TOP LINE

- Another quiet 24-48 hours nationally - no new DfE, Ofsted, safeguarding, SEND or funding announcement cleared the corroboration bar today.
- The Talbot Specialist School (Norton Lees, SEND) strike dispute remains unresolved more than a week after NEU members walked out over workload, safety and governance concerns.

→ **For your school:** *Worth checking directly with Talbot if you route SEND placements or respite support there this month, in case further strike days disrupt provision.*

- Sheffield City Council decides on Monday whether to fund a 90-place temporary expansion at Hinde House 2-16 School, one of three secondary expansions addressing a city-wide shortage of places.
- Reminder: DfE's call for evidence on exclusion reform (behaviour strategies, in-school units, managed moves) closes in 6 days, on 19 November.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

16 Nov 2026 — Sheffield City Council policy committee due to decide £1.1m funding for Hinde House 2-16 School's temporary 90-place expansion.

16-20 Nov 2026 — Anti-Bullying Week 2026 - 'Break the Silence' theme; Odd Socks Day opens the week on 16 Nov.

19 Nov 2026 — DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform (behaviour strategies, in-school units, managed moves) closes - 6 days away.

Nov 2026 (exact day tbc) — DfE due to publish autumn 2025/26 suspensions and permanent exclusions statistics for England.

SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

▪ **Talbot strike still unresolved, over a week on.** NEU members at Talbot Specialist School, the Norton Lees SEND school maintained directly by Sheffield City Council, walked out on 5 November over 'excessive workload, safe working practices and a lack of transparency in school governance', with further strike days called into this fortnight. No settlement has been reported; the council says it has asked the union 'to reconsider their proposed action'. (The Star / Yorkshire Post)

→ **For your school:** *Worth checking directly with the school if you route SEND placements or respite support there this month.*

▪ **Council to rule on Hinde House expansion funding.** Sheffield City Council's policy committee meets 16 November to approve £1.1m for a temporary 90-place expansion at Hinde House 2-16 School in Shiregreen - one of three secondary expansions, alongside Forge Valley and Yewlands, planned to meet a forecast shortage of Year 7 places across the city. (The Star)

JARGON-BUSTER · IN-SCHOOL UNITS & MANAGED MOVES

Two terms likely to recur as DfE's exclusion reform call for evidence closes on 19 November:

An in-school unit is an on-site space pupils are moved to for part of the day instead of being suspended;

a managed move is an agreed, time-limited transfer to a different mainstream school, used as an alternative to permanent exclusion.

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.